GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

August 14th, 2026
Week 33
Volume 282, Issue 1248

Highlights:

- **Talks stall.**
- **Tanks fill.**
- **Freight reverses.**
- **Prints diverge.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"Facts do not cease to exist because they are ignored."
- Aldous Huxley

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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TANKS FILL, TALKS STALL

The diplomacy went quiet this week, and the ships went quieter. Talks between Washington and Tehran on ending the war and reopening Hormuz remain deadlocked, with President Trump asserting that the US holds total control of the waterway while his administration prepares expanded sanctions and tighter blockade enforcement. Five months of strikes have not produced capitulation, and policy is beginning to acknowledge it. Traffic continues under Iran's unratified corridor terms, while Saudi Arabia and the UAE work on alternative export arrangements. Some vessels are reportedly switching off transponders while transiting the strait. The Gulf's newest routing product is invisibility.

Oil rose for five consecutive sessions into Wednesday before Thursday's 2.5% pullback left WTI near USD 81.10 and Brent around USD 86.96, still roughly 5% higher on the week. The IEA more than doubled its estimate of this quarter's global supply deficit to 1.8 million barrels per day, with July supply 6.3 million barrels below a year earlier. In the same week, the EIA reported US crude inventories rising by 17.4 million barrels, the largest weekly build since January 2023, while Saudi output climbed toward 7.4 million barrels per day. The shortage is real. It is also, apparently, unevenly parked.

Freight completed its fourth reversal in as many weeks. The Baltic Dry Index fell for four straight sessions to 2,844, its lowest since August 3, as the Capesize index surrendered 12% on the week to 4,469, including single-day falls of 5.8% and 5.2%. Panamaxes snapped a ten-session winning streak near 2,262, while the Supramax touched a nine-week low of 1,600 before steadying at 1,613. The Baltic remains up 39% on the year and constitutionally incapable of finishing a fortnight without a U-turn. For recycling, the whipsaw keeps churning candidates without quite releasing them.

The data went four ways at once. US CPI printed at 3.4% for July, with core at 2.5%, enough to cool some urgency around further rate increases. India went the other way, with CPI at 4.45%, a 19-month high, led by food. Onions rose 22.5% and ginger, this publication's most reliable correspondent, 83.6%. It was a second month above target, with the RBI seeing a fourth-quarter peak and Morgan Stanley pencilling in 75 basis points of hikes from December. Bangladesh delivered the basin's friendliest print, easing to 8.32% from 9.16%. Currencies barely blinked: USD/INR eased to 95.42, the Taka held near the top of its band, the Lira set fresh records near 47.83, and the Pakistani Rupee closed near 278.20. The covenant holds.

At the beaches, both windows are open at once. Chattogram's August 12 to 15 tide closes tomorrow, with the next running August 28 to 31. Alang's August 9 to 18 window holds the week's most watched arrival, FT Island at 43,402 LDT, the basin's largest candidate in months, now at anchor awaiting its tide.

The market beneath them split cleanly. Alang sentiment cooled again despite local plate recovering to INR 39,500 by Friday, with buying interest remaining selective. Chattogram inverted its recent filter, with aggressive appetite for small and mid-sized tankers lifting specialist quotes by roughly 4.5%, even as caution toward bulkers persists. Gadani held a rare pocket of stability, with secured candidates still in transit. Pine Arrow's Alang delivery was verified in writing at USD 445 per LDT. Turkey remained Turkey.
The tanks are full, the talks are stuck, and the ships have started turning their lights off. The beaches keep the only honest ledger left: two windows open, one giant at anchor, and a price confirmed on paper. The market is no longer waiting for peace. It is pricing around it.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 33 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

THE FILTER FLIPS

Window, open.

The August 12 to 15 tide window opened on Wednesday and closes tomorrow, with deliveries moving through it. The LPG tanker that waited out the fortnight at anchor went onto the plots on opening day, and the anchorage is turning over on schedule. The next window with meaningful capacity runs August 28 to 31, and the monsoon's tail is now a scheduling nuisance rather than an operating constraint. Two windows, two weeks apart, both functioning: the beach's logistics have fully normalised even where its pricing has not.

Tankers, wanted.

The week's sharpest reversal was Chattogram's own. The market that spent July avoiding tanker histories spent this week outbidding everyone for them: recyclers showed exceptionally aggressive interest in small and mid sized tankers, lifting specialist tanker and container quotes by roughly 4.5% week-on-week, even as caution on standard bulkers persists. The compliance filter has inverted; in Chattogram, caution has a shelf life of about 5 weeks. Local plate told the other half of the story. A mid-week rally to BDT 64,500 proved unsustainable, settling back at BDT 64,000 by Friday, which is why the specialist bid, not the steel, is carrying sentiment.

Eight point three two.

The first print of the credibility era arrived friendly: July inflation eased to 8.32% from 9.16%, the softest reading of the year, with food at 7.16% from 8.60% and the moderation broad across rural and urban baskets. Wage growth near 8.2% is, for the first time in years, within touching distance of the price level. USD/BDT held near 123.55 against the top of its band beneath the February 2025 record of 123.87. A bureau under instruction to make its numbers believable produced one worth believing in; the committee's work, presumably, continues.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

HOT PRINT, COOL MARKET

Four four five.

July's CPI rose to 4.45%, a 19-month high and a second consecutive month above the RBI's 4% target, driven almost entirely by food: onions accelerated to 22.5%, garlic to 35.4%, and ginger, this publication's most reliable correspondent, to 83.6%. The Reserve Bank sees the peak arriving in the December quarter; Morgan Stanley now pencils 75 basis points of hikes beginning in December, toward a 6% terminal rate. USD/INR gave back a touch to 95.42, and the currency relief that flattered last month's arithmetic has quietly stopped flattering.

Alang cools.

The fortnight of renewed appetite ended with sentiment softening again and buying interest thinning, even as local plate recovered from INR 38,500 early in the week to INR 39,500 by Friday, with HMS scrap near USD 375. The steel recovery was real; the buying response was considerably less convincing. The August 9 to 18 tide window is open through Tuesday, and the yard-side economics, loading charges and payment discipline, continue their slow renovation beneath a market that keeps waiting for a downstream steel bid that has not arrived.

A price, in writing.

What Alang lacked in momentum it supplied in paper. Pine Arrow's delivery was verified at USD 445 per LDT, the fortnight's second confirmed print, while FT Island, 43,402 LDT of oil tanker and the basin's largest candidate in months, sits at anchor awaiting its tide within the open window. The EU List discussions continue, the dark fleet lane stays open, and the more than 115 valid Statements of Compliance remain the deepest bench in the basin. A cool market with a giant at anchor and a price in writing is still a market worth watching.

MARKET SALE REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
Pine Arrow	General Cargo	12,574	USD 445 / LDT (delivered Alang)

PAKISTAN

A POCKET OF STABILITY

Stable, rare.

In a week when Alang cooled, Chattogram inverted, and the freight market executed its fourth U-turn in as many weeks, Gadani did something genuinely unusual: nothing. Underlying demand continues to strengthen, recyclers remain willing buyers, and the constraint is scarcity of candidates rather than any weakness in appetite. Vessel arrivals remain at a standstill, with the recently secured candidates still in transit. In a basin where every market changed its mind this week, Gadani's refusal to have an opinion is starting to look like strategy.

Plate holds.

Local plate held at PKR 200,000 per ton, near USD 714, still the sub-continent's top quote, with the continued absence of imported Iranian steel keeping mills leaning on recyclers for feedstock and steel prices underpinned by monsoon-related supply friction. The consumption case remains constructive: housing subsidies and the reduced property withholding tax are still expected to lift construction demand once the season clears. The price board has held its shape for a month; what Gadani awaits is not a number but a hull.

Quiet, by design.

USD/PKR closed near 278.20, inside a quarter-rupee range once more, and with July's 9.2% print and the SBP's hold both behind it, Pakistan's macro calendar is empty until September. The covenant, less an exchange rate than a personality, enters its second month unbroken. For owners weighing certainty against basis points, the pitch is unchanged: no tide constraint, hungry yards, a stable currency, and the shortest quiet stretch of paperwork in the basin.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

REPORT LANDS, LIRA SLIDES

The forecast, again.

The central bank's quarterly inflation report, its third of the year, landed on Thursday, the scheduled successor to a May edition that had already lifted the end-2026 path into the mid-20s from the mid-teens. With July's official 31.75% and the independent 50.49% both a week old, the report's task was less to reveal than to reconcile, and the September 10 MPC remains the next live date. Consensus continues to see no room for cuts this year; the oil price will cast the deciding vote, as it has all year.

Records, quietly.

USD/TRY set fresh records near 47.83, the managed slide proceeding on schedule, with the effective overnight rate near 40% still doing the policy work while the headline 37% waits for the disinflation it keeps being promised. The pattern is now familiar enough to set a watch by: the report lands, the forecast rises, the Lira slips half a percent, and everyone agrees the framework is working.

Niche, unmoved.

Aliaga's vessel indications held at USD 262 to 284 per LDT across vessel types, with a sluggish flow of candidates and little change in demand or sentiment. Turkey's franchise remains EU regulation, Basel Convention compliance, and specialist tonnage rather than price, and the watch on the Alang EU List discussions, the one development with any bearing on that franchise, continues from its respectful distance. Four thousand kilometres east, the surveyors are still measuring the moat.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 33 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	445-450 / LDT	470-475 / LDT	480-485 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	443-448 / LDT	463-468 / LDT	473-478 / LDT
3	India	**Softening**	420-425 / LDT	440-445 / LDT	450-455 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	262-264 / LDT	272-274 / LDT	282-284 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *The steel recovered from ships recycled at Alang could approximately build enough railway track to* ***circle the Earth more than 14 times****.*

- *Recycling steel recovered from ships at Alang can require approximately* ***60-70% less energy*** *than producing steel through conventional primary steelmaking routes.*

- *An estimated* ***72.55 million MT of*** CO_2 ***emissions*** *have been avoided through ship recycling at Alang, equivalent to approximately* ***8% of the global shipping industry's annual emissions****.*

IMPORTANT DATES

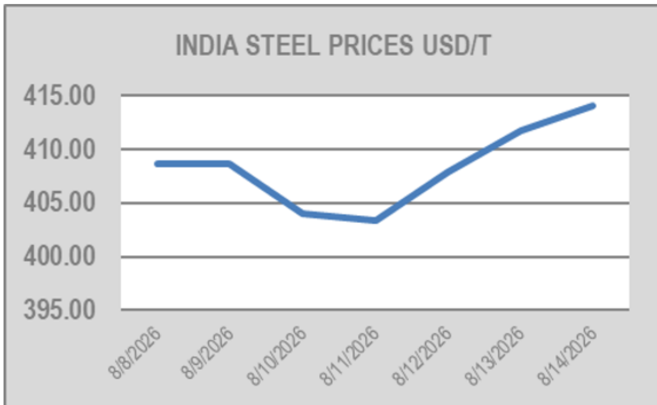
INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 15 – Independence Day	August 09 – August 18 August 26 – September 03

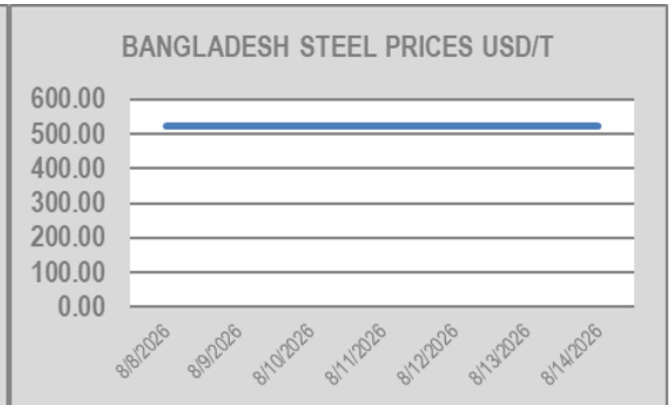
BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 26 - Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi	August 12 – August 15 August 28 – August 31

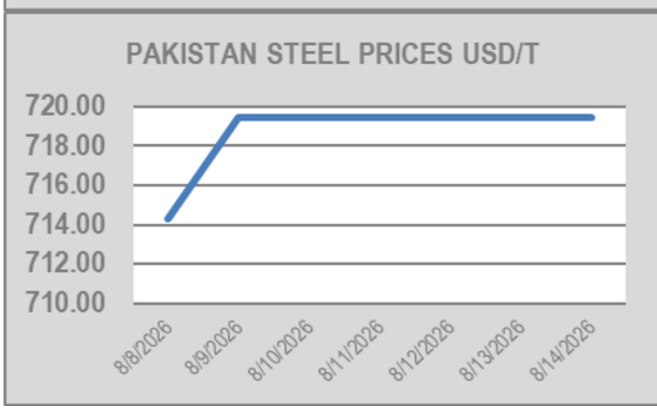
BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
August 25 – Eid Milad-un-Nabi	August 30 – Victory Day

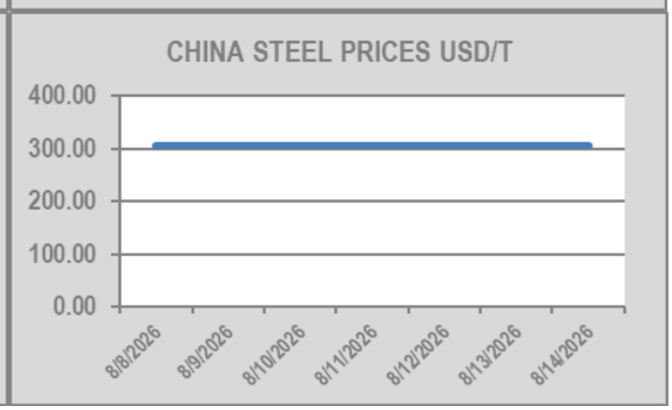
ALANG - Port Position as of August 14, 2026				
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	FT Island	43,402	Oil Tanker	Arrived August 04
CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of August 14, 2026				
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Su Shun	1,660	LPG Tanker	Arrived August 01
GADANI - Port Position as of August 14, 2026				
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
No new vessels reported.				

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
8/8/2026	408.61	38,900.00	714.29	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/9/2026	408.61	38,900.00	719.42	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/10/2026	403.99	38,500.00	719.42	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/11/2026	403.39	38,500.00	719.42	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/12/2026	407.93	38,900.00	719.42	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/13/2026	411.78	39,300.00	719.42	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/14/2026	414.05	39,500.00	719.42	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32









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